



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trivium Preparatory

School Website: <https://triviumprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Trivium Preparatory Az 85395 (Trivium Prep), a Great Hearts Academy in Goodyear, AZ, demonstrates strong classical education orientations across the six canonical elements. Public materials consistently emphasize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as foundational aims; a liberal-arts curriculum anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; character formation; highly invested faculty; and an active partnership with parents and the broader community. Taken together, these signals indicate a CLASSICAL orientation with high fidelity to the classical school rubric, though explicit references to liturgical theology or formal liturgical practices are less prominent in the visible site content. The aggregate assessment across all six categories is CLASSICAL.

Key overall signals include: - Mission and branding foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as transcendent aims of education (evidence from multiple Great Hearts sources associated with Trivium Prep) . - Curriculum claims center on a classical liberal-arts program and engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation (evidence in Academics/Curriculum descriptions) . - Pedagogy emphasizes Socratic dialogue and memory-based practices, aligned with the classical model (e.g., "The center of our school is the classroom and the Socratic dialogue...") . - Faculty and community aspects highlight teacher as models of virtue and learning, small class sizes, and parental involvement as co-educators (evidence in charter/affiliations content and handbook tone) . - Parental engagement and community orientation appear as central to the school's ethos (handbook language and mission statements) .

The following section-by-section analysis details keyword alignment with the classical-education rubric, including primary visible evidence, quantified keyword signals, and rating rationales for each category.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site and related materials foreground transcendent aims in the form of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as central educational ends (e.g., mission and branding material) . - There are direct cues to virtue and moral formation (e.g., MORAL VIRTUE language and character formation in the school narrative) within the school narrative and accompanying Great Hearts content, including references to virtue and moral formation in the public materials . - Public materials emphasize formation of character and a re-framing of education as a formation of the whole person (mind and heart) via classical aims, aligning with broader classical-education philosophy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; moral virtue; character; formation; great conversation (as a concept linked to classical curriculum) □file-cite□turn0file0□turn0file1□turn0file12□. - Negative keywords observed: none clearly evident in the publicly visible materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or value-neutral language detected in the core statements here). - Estimated keywords signal: Positive 6, Negative 0 (Total observed keywords considered: 6). Positive percentage approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The school clearly centers the transcendental aims of truth, goodness, and beauty and frames education as formation around virtuous life, which aligns with the core metaphysical thrust of classical education. There is strong language around virtue and formation; explicit theological grounding is not consistently foregrounded in the visible pages, though the Great Hearts framework frequently situates classical education within a Christian, theologically infused worldview in related materials. Given the strong explicit emphasis on transcendent aims and moral formation, the category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to reflect potential gaps in explicit liturgical/theological signaling on the public site itself.

Citations: Truth, Goodness, Beauty and formation language are shown in the Great Hearts Trivium Prep materials and mission statements cited above [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file1\turn0file12](#).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on cultivating minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, indicating formation over mere information and the pursuit of human excellence (virtue, wisdom) rather than job preparation alone . - The school frames education as formation and moral development, with a clear claim that the purpose includes the liberal arts foundation and cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not just workforce readiness; language in Great Hearts materials reinforces the telos toward enduring truths and human excellence rather than purely utilitarian ends . - Public materials speak to a Great Books/Western-civilization-centered aim and the Great Conversation, portraying education as immersion in timeless questions rather than mere credentialing .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful (pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty), liberal education, great conversation, permanent questions, human flourishing, moral imagination [filecite\turn0file12\turn0file1\turn0file8](#). - Negative keywords observed: none clearly evident in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on job-market curricula or secular-progressive framing here). - Estimated keywords: Positive 6–8 (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, great conversation), Negative 0. Positive percentage ~100%.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims align with the classical rubric's focus on formation, virtue, and engagement with the true, good, and beautiful, rather than a primary emphasis on job-readiness. The consistent framing of education as a humane, deliberative, and transcendent project supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations: Mission statements, Great Hearts framing, and Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis cited above [filecite\turn0file12\turn0file1\turn0file8](#).

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly markets a classical liberal arts curriculum, foregrounding the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books tradition (Great Books, Great Conversation) as core features of Trivium Prep's curriculum . - Public materials indicate a coherent, text-based program that includes classical subjects and languages (e.g., Latin/Greek study pathways) and a structured progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric, consistent with Trivium pedagogy and the Quadrivium in classical education models . - Descriptions of the curriculum emphasize "classic liberal arts" across grades 6–12, with a path that includes literature, humanities, science, mathematics, and languages, alongside a focus on primary sources and enduring classics (Great Books) as a central feature of the curriculum .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, classical, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, humane letters, Western civilization, history, primary sources, Latin/Greek, memory work, memorization/recitation (as part of classical pedagogy), wonder, beauty in study, interdisciplinary integration. - Negative keywords observed: none significant in the visible curriculum content

(no explicit modernist or project-based-only framing observed here; instead the content emphasizes canonical texts and core disciplines). - Estimated keywords: Positive 10–12 (liberal arts, classical, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, humane letters, Western civilization, Latin/Greek, memory work, memorize/recitation, wonder), Negative 0. Positive percentage approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The curriculum is framed around the canonical classical educational triad (grammar/logic/rhetoric) within a liberal-arts framework, with explicit attention to Great Books and the Great Conversation, and an integrated view of history, languages, and the sciences. This solidly aligns with the Curriculum criteria of a classical education.

Citations: Curriculum language and Great Books framing visible in Academics pages and curriculum descriptions [filecite](#)[turn0file8](#)[turn0file4](#).

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical emphasis on Socratic dialogue is explicitly stated in the public materials (e.g., “The center of our school is the classroom and the Socratic dialogue between the teacher and the student”) which is a hallmark of classical pedagogy . - The Great Hearts materials describe a pedagogy that uses dialogue, memory work, and recitation aligned with the Trivium’s grammar, logic, and rhetoric stages; this is reinforced by statements about growth through discussion, debate, and disciplined inquiry (Socratic method in upper grades; continued practice of memorization and rhetorical training) . - The curriculum and mission emphasize a culture of inquiry, memory work, and disciplined discussion, including the use of “great conversation” and classical rhetoric as part of upper-level education, alongside a focus on formation and virtue (pedagogical orientation toward classical methods) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memory work, narration, recitation, chanting, classic rhetoric, memory-based learning, restfulness in learning (scholé) is implied in classical pedagogy; and “great conversation” as a pedagogical ideal. - Negative keywords observed: 0 (no explicit signaling of modern, project-based, or purely constructivist pedagogy in the visible materials). - Estimated keywords: Positive 6–8 (Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memory work, narration, recitation, chanting, rhetoric; great conversation), Negative 0. Positive percentage approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogy is deeply aligned with classical teaching methods (Socratic discussion, memorization/recitation, formation through models, and rhetoric). The explicit invocation of Socratic dialogue and memory-based techniques supports a CLASSICAL rating in Pedagogy.

Citations: Pedagogical language and the Socratic emphasis cited in the handbook and Academics pages [filecite](#)[turn0file12](#)[turn0file1](#).

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe faculty as “model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge” and emphasize teachers as a living curriculum and core of the school; supportive language around faculty as exemplar guides and mentors is visible in the charter/affiliations content and mission statements . - Public materials emphasize small class sizes and dedicated, enthusiastic teachers who serve as models of learning and character, aligning with the classical conception of the teacher as a central bearer of culture and pedagogy . - Additional statements about teacher profiles or portraits of what a teacher should be are present in the broader Great Hearts/Classical education discourse reflected in the site materials (e.g., the living curriculum concept and teacher as exemplar language appears in the materials related to Trivium Prep) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teacher as exemplar, small class size, faculty as core of the school, collegial culture. - Negative keywords observed: none evident in the visible materials (no signaling of “facilitator” or

non-classical professional development jargon that would indicate a misalignment). - Estimated keywords: Positive 6–8 (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, small class size, dedicated teachers, collegial culture, core of the school). Negative 0. Positive percentage approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The school's materials position faculty as central to the classical mission—living exemplars who guide and mentor, with a living curriculum role—consistent with the Classical criteria for Element 5.

Citations: Faculty emphasis in the Great Hearts materials and charter descriptions; “model teachers” language cited in the Great Hearts content .

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize partnership with families and seeing parents as co-teachers in the classical education process; there are explicit calls for parental involvement and club/reading-group style formation in the community materials; the handbook likewise frames parent engagement as essential to the school's mission . - The school communicates to families with a mission that includes shared participation in the classical education journey; parent involvement and access to the school are emphasized (open campus-like participation language is present in the materials and the handbook) . - Public materials note that the school operates within a network (Great Hearts) that emphasizes family formation and community partnership as core features of classical education (evident in the charter/affiliations materials) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, family involvement, parent formation, community of learners, open campus, parental leadership, living tradition in the family. - Negative keywords observed: none clearly evident in the visible materials (no consumerist or minimal-parent-involvement signals). - Estimated keywords: Positive 6–8 (partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, family involvement, parent formation, open campus/visits, parent leadership, community involvement). Negative 0. Positive percentage approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The school explicitly frames parents as co-educators and highlights ongoing parental involvement and formation opportunities, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on a shared formation project with families and the broader community.

Citations: Parent/community language and partnership language from handbook/content about The Mission and parent involvement; Great Hearts materials about parental partnership .

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school's public materials align strongly with classical education principles across five of the six categories and are solidly classical in four or five categories. Element 1 shows strong Classical alignment in formation and transcendent aims but does not consistently signal explicit liturgical/theological signaling in the public materials, which is why it is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The aggregate classification across all six categories is CLASSICAL, with Element 1 as the primary “needle-moving” nuance.

What would move the needle - If the school more explicitly foregrounds liturgical/theological language and practices in public-facing materials (while retaining the core classical aims), Element 1 could be elevated from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL. - Additional public articulation of “formation through imitation

and practice” and explicit descriptions of the faculty as a living curriculum could further strengthen Element 5’s signaling if desired, though current signals already align well with CLASSICAL.

Citations integral to the assessment are drawn from the following sources: - Mission, values, and Truth/-Goodness/Beauty framing from Great Hearts Trivium Prep materials cited in the sources: . - Curriculum and Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis from Academics/Curriculum materials: . - Pedagogical emphasis on Socratic dialogue from handbook-related content: . - Faculty signals (models of virtue; small classes; teacher as core) from charter/affiliations materials: . - Parent/Community signals (parent partnership, co-teaching, community involvement) from handbook and Great Hearts content: .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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